

Categories

payments logic Any change touching payment processing, billing calculations, refunds, retries on payment operations, or webhook handlers for payment events. Files typically under `billing/`, `payments/`, `refunds/`.

config change Changes to configuration values, feature flags, environment variables, or non-code settings that don't alter application logic. Files typically `.yaml`, `.env`, `.json` config files, or explicit config modules.

text/copy change Changes limited to user-facing text, labels, marketing copy, or static content with no logic, no data handling, and no dependency impact. Files typically `.txt`, `.md`, or clearly-scoped string literals in UI templates.

auth/permissions Any change to authentication flows, authorization checks, access control rules, session handling, or permission scopes. Files typically under `auth/`, `permissions/`, `middleware/`.

data schema migration Any change that alters a database schema, table structure, or data model, including migrations, index changes, and field additions/removals.

infra/scaling Changes to deployment configuration, autoscaling rules, resource limits, or infrastructure-as-code, not covered by config change because these directly affect system capacity and availability, not just settings.

Classification Rule

If a change spans more than one category (e.g. touches both payments logic and a data schema migration), classify it under whichever category carries the higher inherent risk, in this order from highest to lowest: **auth/permissions** > **payments logic** > **data schema migration** > **infra/scaling** > **config change** > **text/copy change**.

When to flag ambiguous instead of classifying

Flag a submission as ambiguous, rather than forcing a category, when:

- The change doesn't clearly match any category definition above
- The change touches files in more than two of the categories above simultaneously, suggesting it should potentially be split into separate submissions
- The file path or change description gives genuinely insufficient information to determine what the change does

Do not default to the lowest-risk category when uncertain. Ambiguous cases route to escalation regardless of how small the change looks.